



A SIMPLE GUIDE FOR STUDENTS & FRESHERS

How to Get a Core Engineering Job

No jargon. No confusion. Just the exact steps to go from "I don't know where to start" to "I got the job" — explained in plain English.

[Check your resume free on NextRaise.ai →](#)

Save this guide on your phone. Read it once now, and open it again every time you apply.

First, what is a "core" job? It's a job in your own engineering branch — not software/IT. So if you studied Mechanical, a core job is making, designing, or testing machines. Civil? Building roads, bridges, buildings. Electrical? Power, motors, and electronics. You'll find these jobs at companies like Tata, L&T, Mahindra, Bosch, Siemens, BHEL, ABB, Maruti, JSW, and NTPC. Good news: fewer students apply for core than for IT, so a smart application gets noticed quickly. This guide shows you how, one step at a time.

1 Know your basics really well

In a core interview, they won't ask you to code. They'll ask you simple, deep questions about what you studied. So before applying, make sure you can explain:

- **4 or 5 of your main subjects** — don't try to revise everything. Pick a few from your branch and know them well. (Example: Mechanical → Thermodynamics, Strength of Materials.)
- **Your college projects** — what you built, why you built it, and what you would do better next time. They love asking about projects.
- **The tools you used** — like AutoCAD, SolidWorks, ANSYS, MATLAB, or STAAD.Pro. Only mention the ones you can actually open and use.

- **Any internship or plant visit** — even a short one counts, as long as you can explain what you saw and learned.

Simple rule: If you wrote it on your resume, you must be able to explain it. Never add a skill you can't talk about.

2 Make a resume that gets you noticed

A resume is a one-page summary of you. For most jobs, a computer or a busy recruiter scans it for just a few seconds first. So keep it **one page**, clean, and easy to read.

The biggest trick: every job post (called a **JD** — Job Description) lists what they want. Use the *same words* they use. If the JD says "AutoCAD" and you know AutoCAD, write "AutoCAD" — not "drafting software".

Put this on your resume	Here's what it means
Your details	Name, phone, a professional email, your city, and LinkedIn link. No photo unless they ask.
A 2-line intro	Your branch, your best skill, and the job you want. Short and simple.
Projects	Your strongest section. For each one: what was the goal → what <i>you</i> did → which tools → the result.
Internships	Company name, your role, dates, and 2–3 lines on what you did.
Skills	Software, technical, and people skills. Keep it honest.
Education	Your degree, college, marks (CGPA or %), and year.

Weak vs strong: Instead of "Worked on jig fixtures", write "Redesigned a jig fixture and cut assembly time by 18%." Numbers make recruiters stop and read.

Easy way: let NextRaise.ai check your resume for you

Not sure if your resume is good enough? **NextRaise is a free AI helper for job hunting.** Just paste the job description, and it will:

- **Fix your resume to match the job** — so it says what the recruiter is looking for
- **Give you a "match score"** — a number out of 100 that tells you how well you fit, *before* you apply
- **Find jobs for you** and let you **apply in one click**

Think of it as a friend who checks your resume before you send it. That one check is often the difference between "no reply" and "you're shortlisted".

Try it free →

3 Know where to look for core jobs

Core jobs are not all in one place like IT jobs. So check all of these:

- **Company websites** — the best source. Pick 15–20 companies you like and check their "Careers" page every week.
- **Job apps** — LinkedIn, Naukri, Indeed, and Internshala. Turn on job alerts with your branch name.
- **NextRaise.ai** — to see jobs that match your profile and apply in one click ([open here](#)).
- **Government / PSU jobs** — big companies like NTPC, IOCL, BHEL, and ONGC hire through the GATE exam. Watch their notice pages.
- **Your college placement cell** — many core companies hire only through campus. Don't skip it.
- **Seniors and alumni** — someone you know already working in a core company can refer you. One referral beats 100 cold applications.

4 Apply the smart way (not the spray-everywhere way)

- **Change your resume a little for each job** — keep one main resume, then tweak the intro and skills to match each company.
- **Apply early** — core jobs often close fast. Try to apply in the first 1–2 days after it's posted.
- **Add a short note** if there's space — just 3–4 lines on why you want that job. It shows effort.
- **Keep a simple list** — in a notebook or sheet: company, role, date applied, and what happened. So you don't forget or apply twice.
- **Follow up politely** after a week or so, especially if a senior referred you.

Remember: 10 carefully made applications beat 100 copy-paste ones. Recruiters can tell when you didn't try.

5 Get ready for the interview

The technical round (about your subject)

- They ask questions from your main subjects and your projects — so revise both together.
- Be ready for "Where is this used in real life?" and "What happens if it fails?"
- Keep a pen ready — you may be asked to draw a simple diagram or do a small calculation.

The HR round (about you)

- Practice easy answers for: "Tell me about yourself", "Why this company?", and "What are your strengths and weaknesses?"
- Say yes to working at plants or different cities if you can — core companies really value this.
- Keep 2 simple questions ready to ask *them*. It shows you're genuinely interested.

6 Mistakes to avoid

- ✗ Sending the exact same resume to every company.
- ✗ Writing software or skills you can't actually use.
- ✗ Skipping core because "IT pays more" — then being unprepared for both.
- ✗ Applying late, after the job is basically full.
- ✗ Having no LinkedIn, or one that's empty.

Quick checklist before you hit "Apply"

- ✓ My resume is one page, clean, and matches this job
- ✓ I checked my resume on NextRaise.ai and improved my match score
- ✓ Every skill I listed is something I can actually do
- ✓ My projects show: goal → what I did → tools → result (with a number)
- ✓ My LinkedIn is updated and matches my resume
- ✓ I'm applying early, through the right place
- ✓ I've revised my main subjects and project for the interview
- ✓ I wrote this application down in my tracking list

Your very first step

Pick just one job you like. Run your resume through NextRaise to get your match score and a better version. Then apply. Do the same for the next job. Small, smart steps win — keep going and you'll get there.

[Start now — it's free →](#)